

BEAST

Mind of a genius, body of a wild thing!

BEAST

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Henry P. "Hank" McCoy

OCCUPATION

Adventurer, biochemist

BASE

The Xavier Institute, Salem Center, New York

HEIGHT 5 ft 11 in

WEIGHT 402 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Brown (originally); blue-black (currently)

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men Vol. 1 #1
(September 1963)

POWERS

The Beast possesses superhuman strength, agility, durability, and enhanced senses, including catlike night vision. He is able to recover with superhuman swiftness from minor wounds. He also possesses genius-level IQ, with extraordinary expertise in genetics, biochemistry and other subjects.



Dr. McCoy recklessly drank his own serum, which gave him a more bestial form and increased superpowers.

UNCHAINED

Under Xavier's tutelage McCoy earned his Ph.D. and went on to become a genetic researcher at the Brand Corporation. There he developed a serum that further mutated him: he grew fur all over his body, as well as fangs and pointed ears.

Initially McCoy attempted to masquerade as a normal human by using a latex mask and gloves. However, the Beast abandoned this disguise, joined the AVENGERS, and publicly revealed his true identity. Later, the Beast reorganized another team, the DEFENDERS. After this incarnation of the Defenders collapsed, the Beast rejoined Xavier's other four original X-Men in a new mutant team, X-FACTOR. Soon afterwards, the Beast was captured by former Brand scientist Dr. Carl Maddicks, who used a serum to cause the Beast to revert to his previous, more human appearance. Still later, the mutant INFECTIA's powers returned the Beast to his fur-covered form.

Though the Beast can be fierce in battle, paradoxically he is also a man of high intellect, sharp wit, and great kindness.

Nuclear-power-plant worker Norton McCoy was exposed to intense radiation, and his son Henry was born a mutant, with unusually large hands and feet. Henry's schoolmates called him "Beast," but his mutant physique enabled him to become a star football player. When a criminal called the Conquistador abducted Henry's parents to force Henry to work for him, the X-Men came to the rescue. The team's founder, Professor X, recruited Henry and, codenamed the Beast, he thus became one of the X-Men's original members.



BEAST WITH THE X-MEN

1 Wolverine 2 Jean Grey 3 Beast (wearing reading glasses) 4 Professor X 5 Emma Frost 6 Cyclops

The Beast has grown more massive and more feline in appearance: his face now resembles a lion's.



THE APPLIANCE OF SCIENCE

The original members of X-Factor rejoined the X-Men, and McCoy succeeded in creating a cure for the Legacy Virus, drawing on research by DR. MOIRA MACTAGGERT. After the Beast was nearly killed in combat, fellow member SAGE saved his life by using her powers to mutate him even further. He worked harder than anyone to find way to restore mutant powers lost on M-DAY, but he has so far failed. He currently lives with the X-Men in San Francisco. **PS, MF**



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• X-Men Vol. 1 #49-53

The extraordinary origin of the Beast explained for the first time.

• Amazing Adventures Vol. 2 #11-16

the Beast mutates into his furry ape-like form and combats the Secret Empire.

• X-Treme X-Men #3

The Beast mutates into his leonine form.